MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and has built merge-request ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Experienced in improving pipeline performance, infrastructure automation, observability for test metrics, and cross-team technical documentation. Building further infrastructure-as-code and Kubernetes experience through a personal k3s and Terraform project.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CI/CD and build tooling: GitLab CI, Jenkins, pipeline optimization, artifact publishing
Containers and orchestration: Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; basic), k3s
Infrastructure as code and automation: Terraform (personal project), Ansible (basic), Bash, Python
Observability and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Operating systems and version control: Linux, Git
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal free tier)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | Wroclaw
2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelizing test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments comprising an application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deployed via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI; environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a Python and PostgreSQL pipeline-results workflow and Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed test data in PostgreSQL.
- Wrote the internal guide to CI pipelines used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster; deploys applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, with Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Delivered short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments with seeded data for each merge request, deployed with Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Set environments to be destroyed automatically after merge or 48 hours of inactivity, enabling QA and product review before merge and end-to-end testing against the environment.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- The flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams began addressing the leading offenders.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelized test jobs, added dependency caching and separated end-to-end testing into its own stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam; exam scheduled for January 2027.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)